

Term	Short	Spec Details	Description
Concrete Path		<i>this spec</i>	a path that is not a group or wildcard path (see Concrete Path)
Existent Path		<i>this spec</i>	a concrete path that exists on a server cluster (see Existent Path)
Supported		Data Model	the indicated element is supported by the implemented instance
Unsupported		Data Model	the indicated element is not supported by the implemented instance

8.1.6. Conventions & Conformance

See the [Data Model](#) specification.

8.2. Concepts

Relationships between devices are established using data model elements and interactions defined here. See the [System Model](#) specification for more information.

An interaction is a sequence of transactions. A transaction is a sequence of actions.

An action is a single logical communication from a source node to one or more destination nodes. An action is conveyed by one or more messages.

The actual construction and encoding of messages is left to the message layer, which is the layer below this layer.

- The protocol layers below this layer MAY have constraints that only support a subset of the functionality described here.

Examples:

- A client may choose Read interactions instead of Subscribe interactions.
- A client may choose to not Write or Invoke commands.

8.2.1. Path

A path is used to indicate one or more element instances in the data model. The path has the form as described in Augmented Backus–Naur:

```
<path> ::= <target> <cluster> <cluster element>
```